

PRESENTED BY
Kabos Monalisa

Company
Knode.ai

THE AI COACHING PLATFORM

From Invisible Backend to
Engaging Coaching Product



My challenge

The AI coaching platform hadn't launched publicly yet. The team was in ideation mode, testing too many features at once and jumping to user-suggested solutions, without spending enough time in the problem space.

I joined as their founding designer to figure out why users weren't connecting with the interface. My challenge was to get the team to slow down and stop reacting to what users said they wanted — and start uncovering what they actually needed.

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Overview

Knodel.ai is an AI startup that helps sales teams improve performance by analyzing and scoring sales calls. It turns raw call data into insights managers can use to coach reps more effectively, helping sales teams close more deals.

My Role

I joined as a consultant and founding designer, working with the Product Lead and Product Manager to design the first UI/UX layer of the platform—turning complex AI outputs into intuitive coaching experiences sales managers could use.

Business Goals

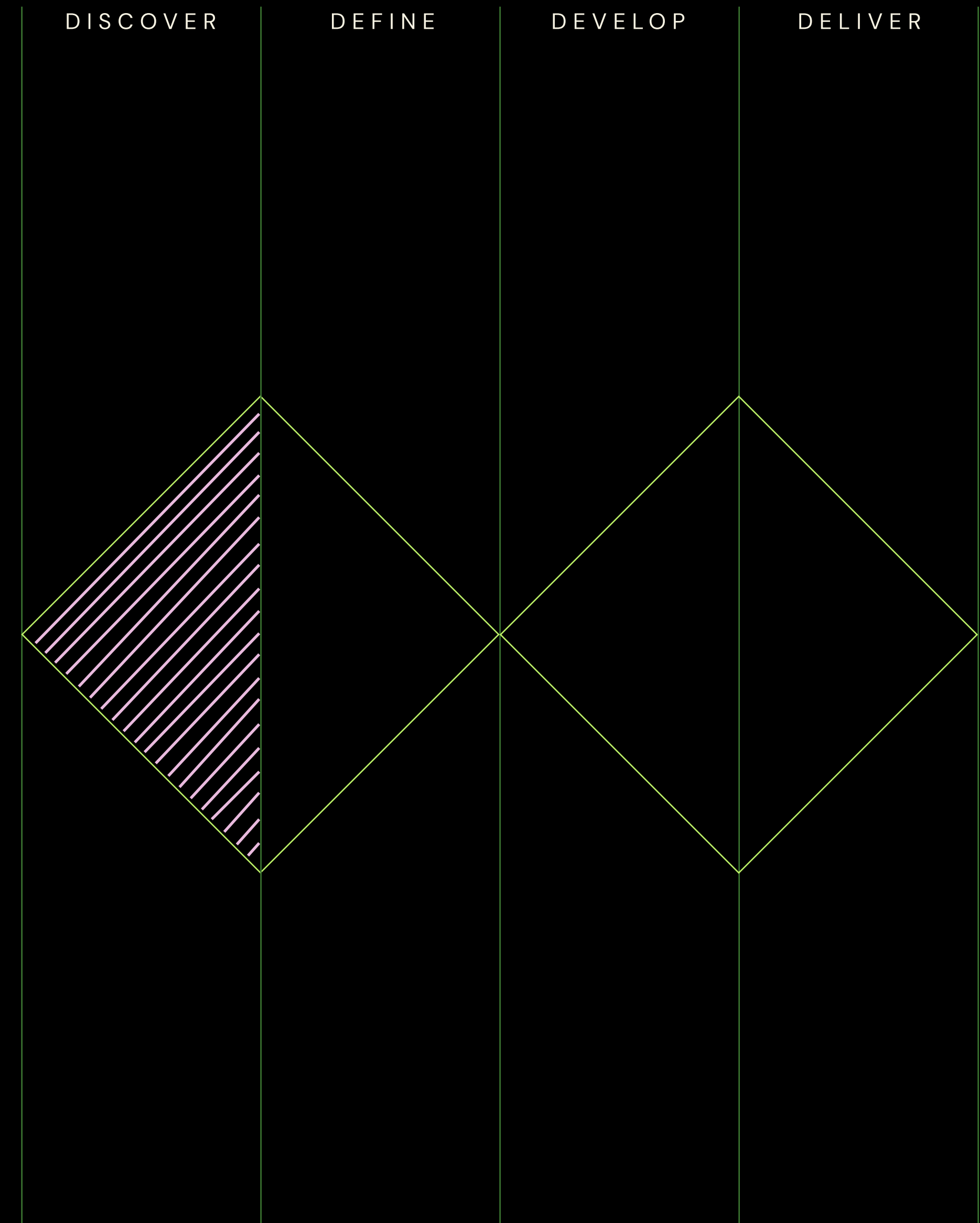
Support sales managers in giving effective 1:1 coaching to reps

Knodel's goal was to move beyond backend call scoring and deliver a product that sales managers could rely on in their weekly coaching sessions.



DISCOVER

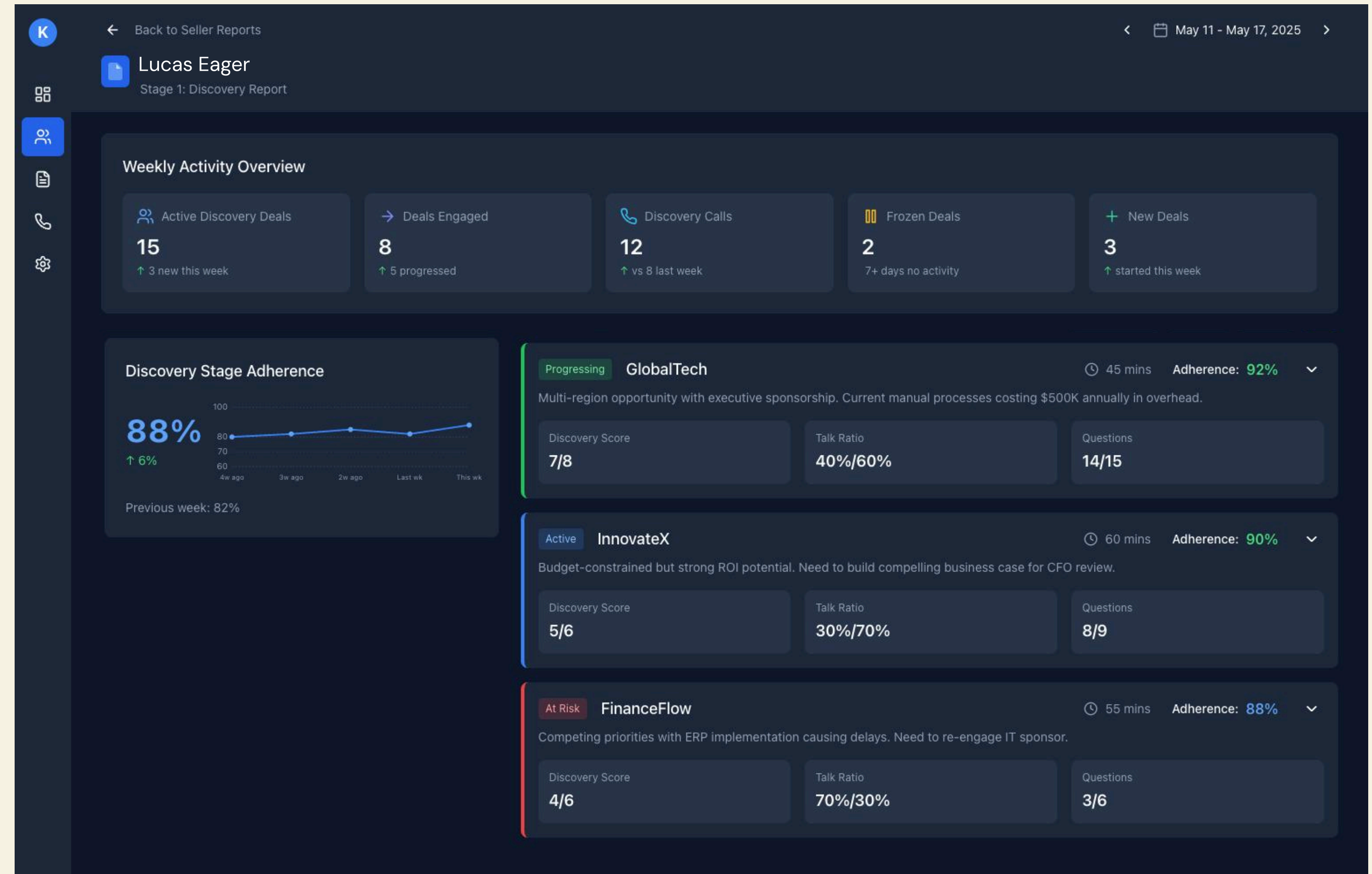
I joined 4 product interviews with sales managers and reps, supporting with questions and observing how they reacted to early AI-generated prototypes that had been created before I joined.



#Key insights from interviews

The team was testing a dashboard showing raw playbook-adherence scores and call metrics.

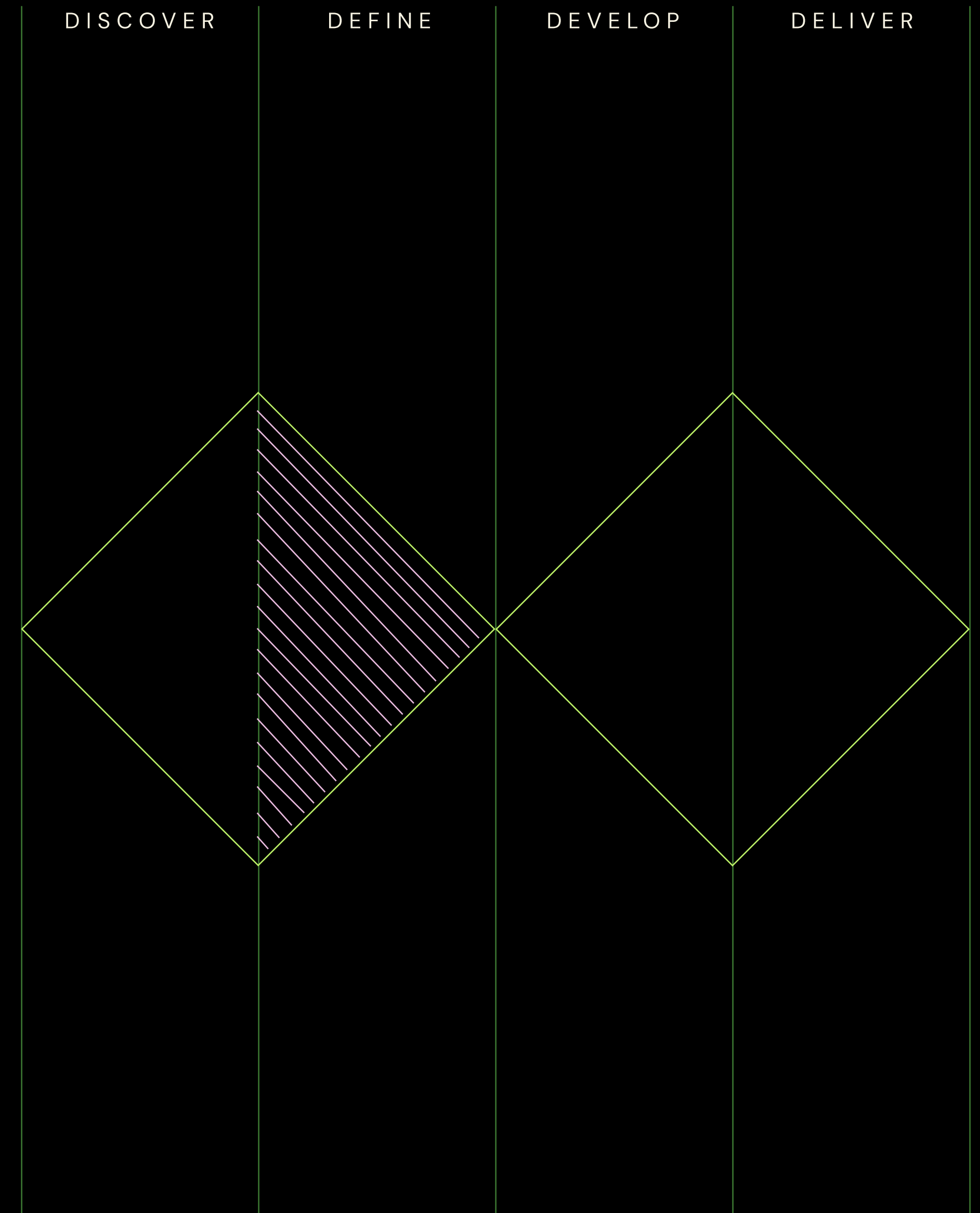
- Managers understood the numbers, but struggled to translate them into coaching.
- With limited time, they needed a way to quickly spot where reps required attention before weekly 1:1s.



Prototype the team built for testing before I joined.

DEFINE

I reviewed the interview notes and discovery sessions and distilled them into a single problem statement we could align on as a team.



Root Problem

No clear path from scores to coaching

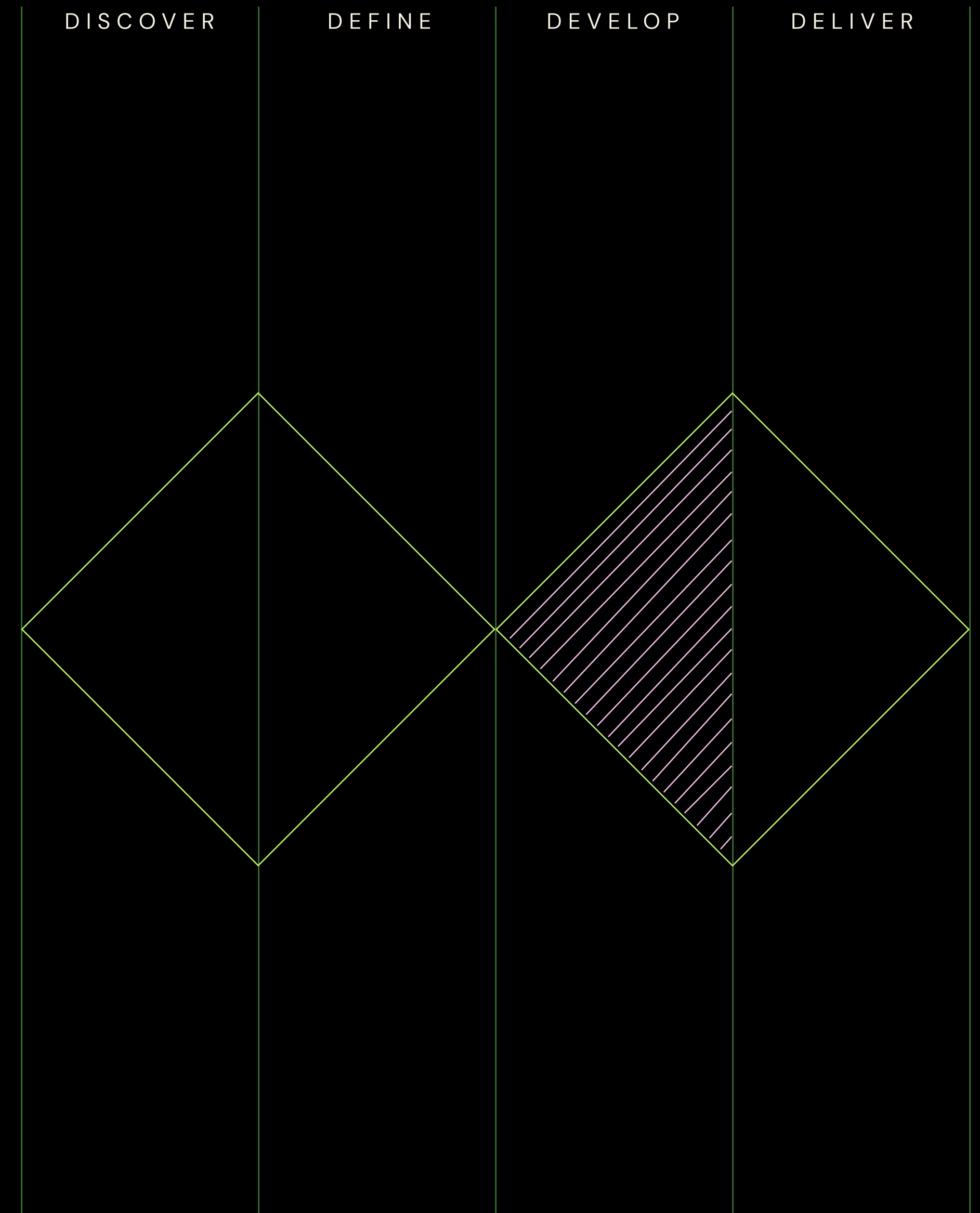
The AI surfaced long lists of playbook-adherence scores, but managers couldn't connect them to their 1:1 coaching conversations.



How might we turn the AI playbook scores into something managers can actually use in weekly 1:1s?

DEVELOP

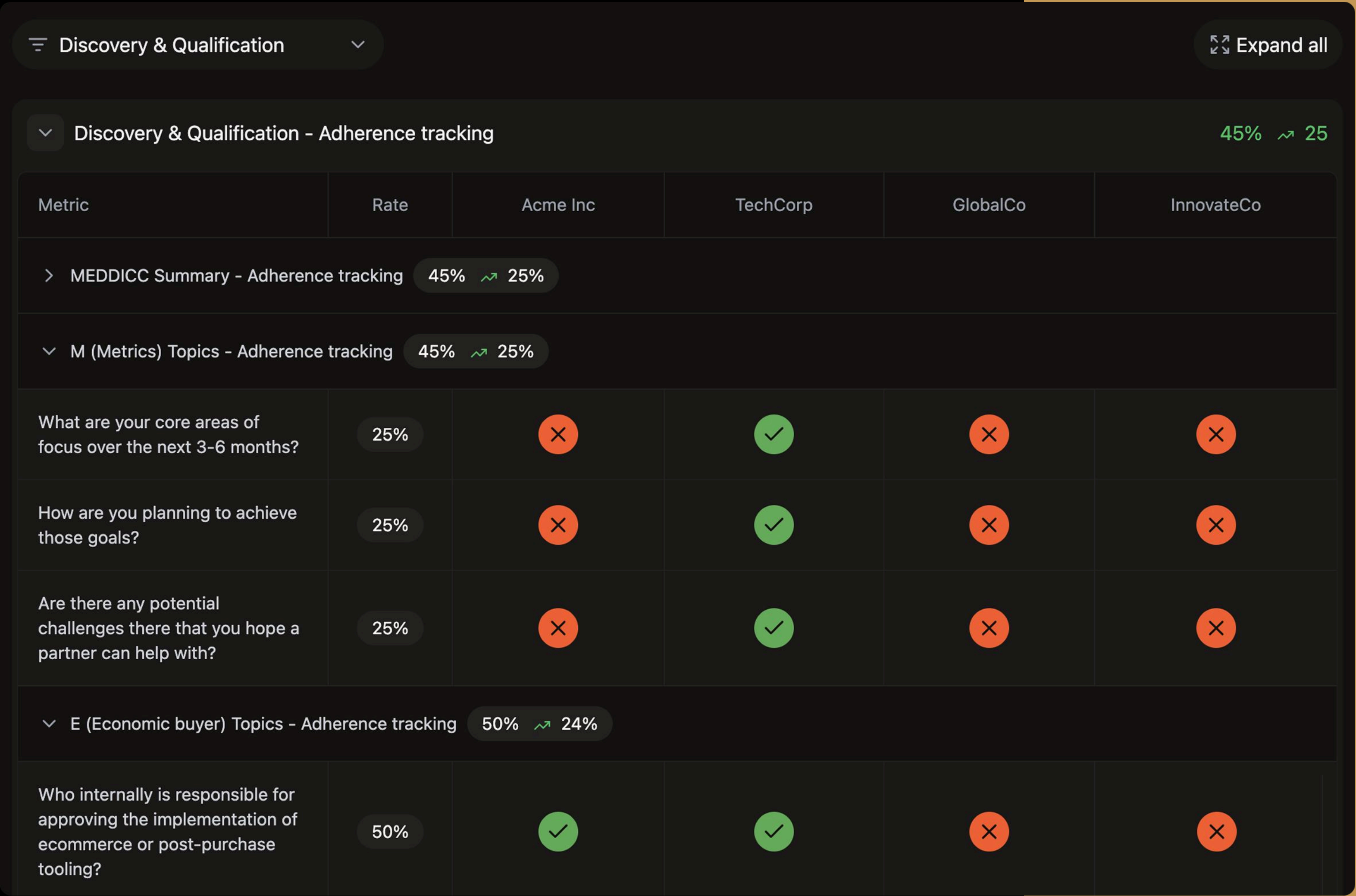
I translated the problem into prototypes, testing different ways of organizing the AI scores so managers could connect them to their coaching.



Experiment #1 → Iteration #1

Call-by-call context

I designed a view that broke metrics down by individual calls. Managers could compare across clients and quickly see where a rep needed coaching.



Prototype showing metrics across calls and within each call.

#Key insights

2 live 30-min sessions with sales managers

Managers loved the view, but needed to see proof

Managers loved seeing context across calls and criteria — it let them spot coaching needs at a glance with low effort.

But they also needed proof: details showing why a criteria was or wasn't met, so they could fully trust the scores our AI generated.

Experiment #1 → Iteration #2

Context with proof

In the next iteration, I added a side panel that opened when managers clicked any red or green cell in the matrix. It showed the reasoning and transcript proof for that criteria, and allowed them to move through calls directly from the side panel to see the pattern in the reps behavior across calls.

Discovery & Qualification

Discovery & Qualification - Adherence tracking

Metric	Rate	Acme Inc	TechCorp
> MEDDICC Summary - Adherence tracking 45% ↗ 25%			
M (Metrics) Topics - Adherence tracking 45% ↗ 25%			
What are your core areas of focus over the next 3-6 months?	25%	✗	✓
How are you planning to achieve those goals?	25%	✗	✓
Are there any potential challenges there that you hope a partner can help with?	25%	✗	✓
E (Economic buyer) Topics - Adherence tracking 50% ↗ 24%			
Who internally is responsible for approving the implementation of ecommerce or post-purchase tooling?	50%	✓	✓

TechCorp

Identify and quantify core business pain

Successfully Executed

Reasoning

Successfully identified fuel costs (\$180K/month) as primary pain, quantified at 35% of operating costs vs 28% previously

Evidence from Transcript

View in Gong

Riccardo Pellegrini · 00:01:20

Cost per mile is crucial for competitive positioning. Can you help me understand your current monthly fuel spend?

Amanda Foster · 00:01:45

We're spending approximately \$125K per month on fuel across our fleet.1

Riccardo Pellegrini · 00:04:40

That's \$1.5 million annually. Why do you think your fuel costs are currently so high?

Amanda Foster · 00:05:05

Our drivers don't always make optimal fueling

Rubric Criteria

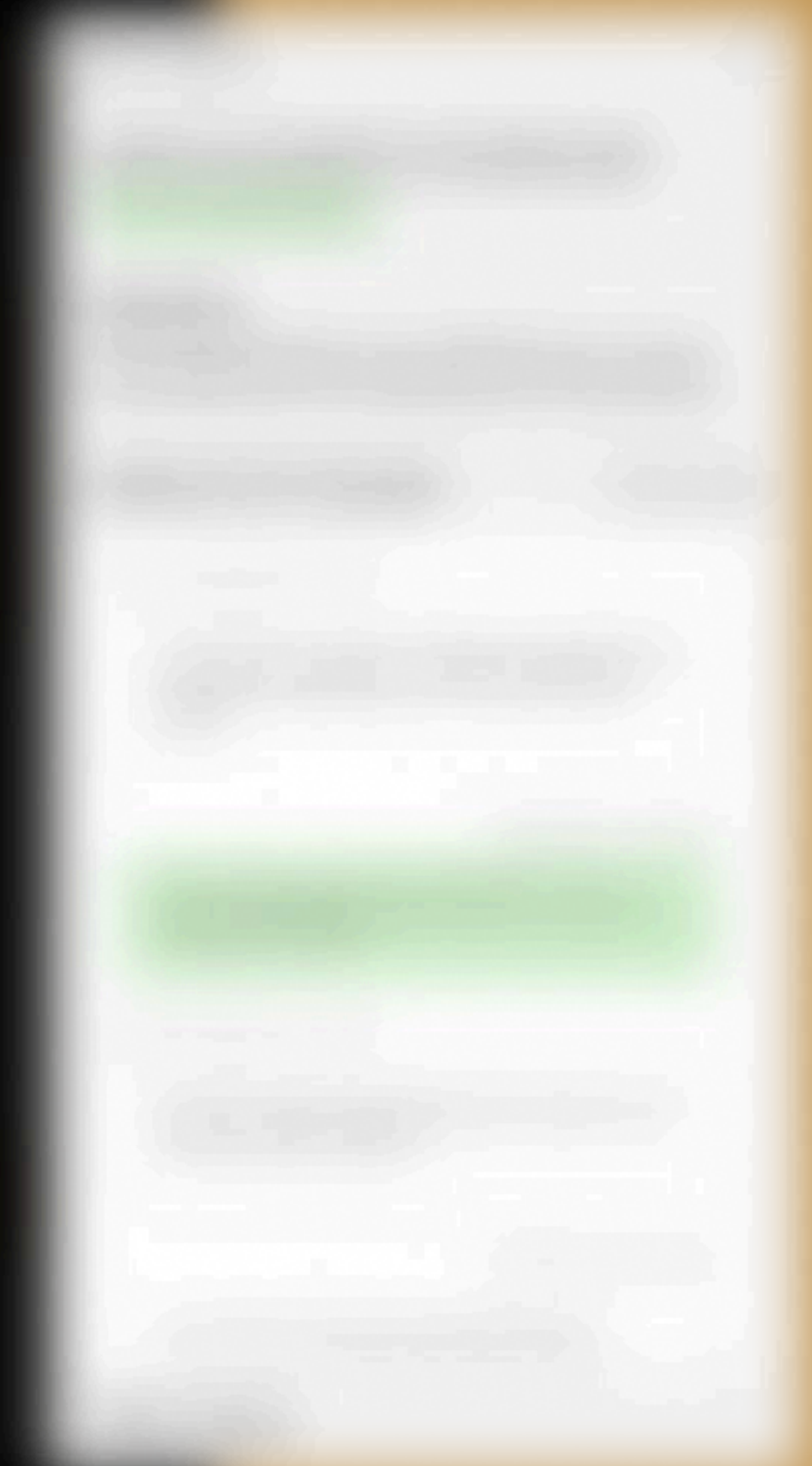
Prototype with side panel showing reasoning and transcript proof.

#Key insights

2 live 30-min sessions with sales managers

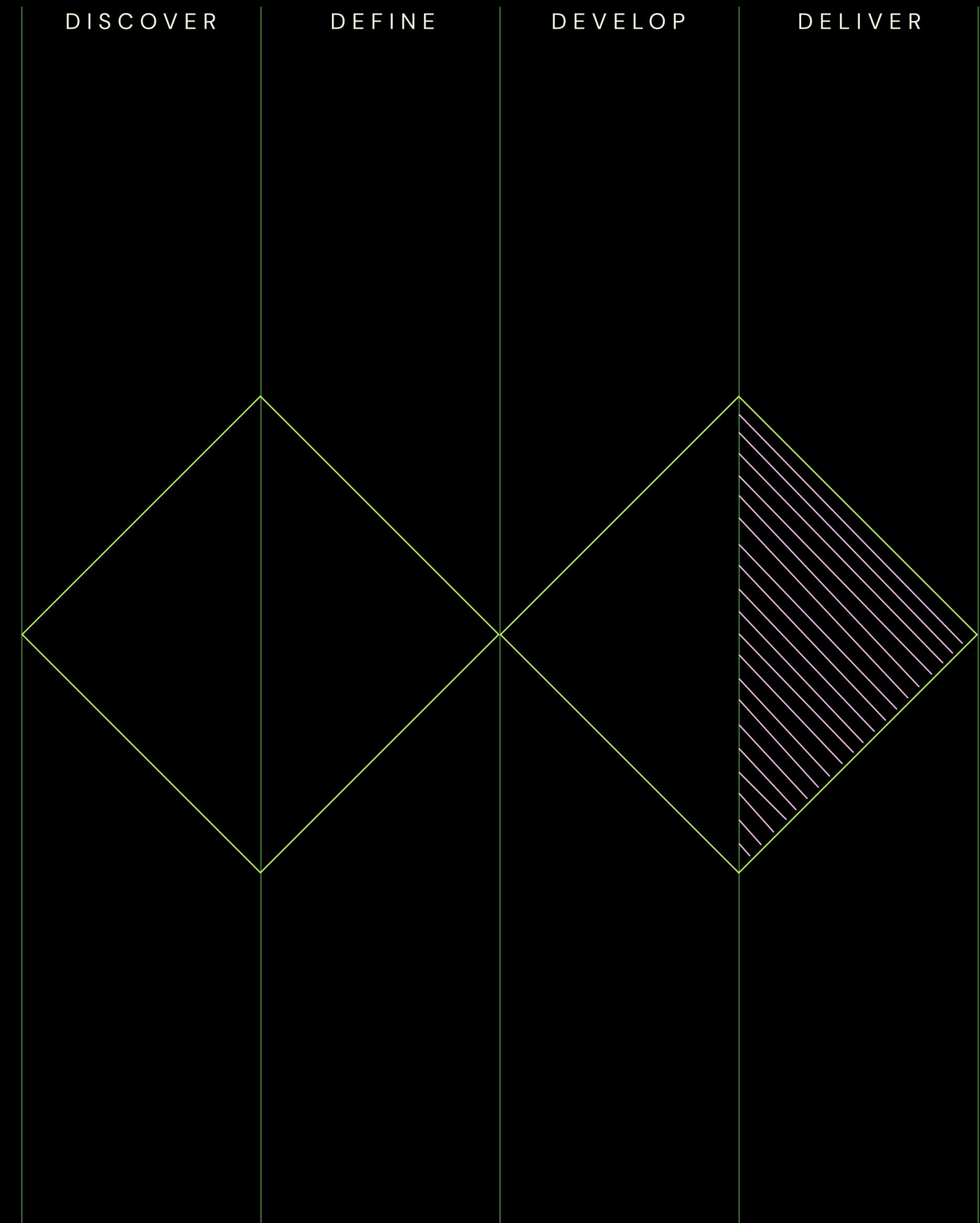
Managers trusted the scores when they saw the proof.

The side panel gave them reasoning and transcript evidence, and they loved being able to click through calls without breaking their workflow.

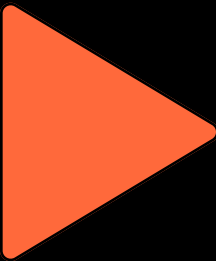


DELIVER

We transformed a backend scoring system into a coaching product managers wanted to use. With context across calls and proof behind the scores, managers could finally coach effectively using the AI.



Before



Knoda Dev

Dashboard

Reports

Report Configurations

Users

Integrations

Report Details

[← BACK TO REPORTS LIST](#)

Seller Report: Davina Saturne

Created: April 30th, 2025 11:49 PM

Areas of Success

- Securing next steps: On 2 of 3 calls (66%), Seller scheduled a follow-up call. On 3 of 3 calls (100%), Seller identified concrete next steps.
- Situation discovery: On 3 of 3 calls (100%), Seller asked Situation discovery questions.
- Core message delivery: On 3 of 3 calls (100%), Seller communicated core value messaging (Lead with Efficiency, Boost Revenue, and Seamless Communication).

Objections Status Summary

- On 3 of 3 calls (100%), Prospects raised one objection: I have to check with my boss.

Closing the Deal Behaviors Summary

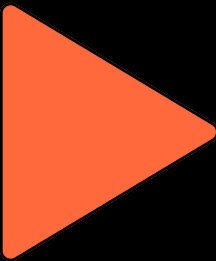
- On 3 of 3 calls (100%), Seller identified concrete next steps.
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Monalisa Kabos

Early product version: dashboard of raw playbook-adherence scores.

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Before



Dashboard

Reports

Report Configurations

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Discovery & Qualification

Demo & Pitch Delivery

Objection Handling

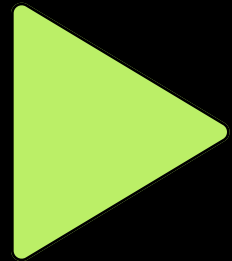
Additional Insights

New Objections Identified	Count	Description
Customer Service	1	Prospect asked about customer service.
Data Transfer	1	Prospect asked if Tripleseat helped with transferring data from the old platform.
EventUp Google Rank	1	Prospect googled EventUp during call to see how it ranked.
Edit Access Permissions	1	Prospect brought up the ability of other team members being able to access and edit event documentation.

Feature Request	Count	Description
Inventory calculation	1	Prospect requested inventory management to be able to track items used during events to avoid double booking auxiliary items like step and repeats, projectors, etc.
Tour scheduling feature	1	Prospect mentioned wanting to be able to book tours of the facility as well as rentals of space.

Competitor Name	Count	Description
Jonas	1	Prospect indicated use of Jonas with note of time wasted on manual entry of event creation.

After



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Lucas Edger
 68% ↗ 7%

☰ Discovery & Qualification ▾

🔍 Expand all

◀ Aug 17 - Aug 24 ▶

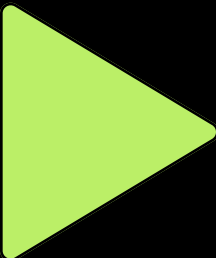
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Discovery & Qualification - Adherence tracking

45% ↗ 25

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After



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Acme Inc

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✕

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Evidence from Transcript

View in Gong

<Evidence 1 of 4>

Sarah Johnson · 00:01:15

Thanks for taking the time today, Michael and Jennifer. I know how busy you both are. Before we dive in, could you tell me a bit about what prompted you to look at fleet optimization solutions right now?

Michael Torres · 00:01:45

Absolutely. We're seeing fuel costs that are just crushing our margins. We're spending about \$180,000 a month on fuel, and it feels like it's getting worse every quarter.¹

Sarah Johnson · 00:02:10

That's significant. When you say it's getting worse every quarter, what operational challenges would derail your fleet

Impact That Transformed Knode.ai



Automated >50% of sales coaching tasks.

Within a week, past critics reached out with positive feedback.

Built the first UI/UX layer, creating a foundation for scalable growth.

Helped company land over \$300K in new contracts.

